

art summit

The Right Strokes

DELHI This may well be the ultimate wish list for an Indian art collector worth the canvas on his wall. India's first-ever organised art collective, The India Art Summit (IAS) 2008, between August 22 and 24 at Pragati Maidan, features over 200 artists and 34 galleries. For India, this is as big as it gets, with F.N. Souza, M.F. Husain, S.H. Raza, Anjolie Ela Menon, Jitish Kallat, Atul Dodiya and Krishen Khanna, all under one roof. "It's a fantastic time for Indian art," says Phillip Hoffman of the Fine Art Fund Group, UK, which is raising \$25 million (Rs 107 crore) for an Indian fine arts fund. Ironically, there has never been a concentrated effort by either the government or private organisations to display Indian art in the country or abroad. "This summit is a fantastic opportunity for us to showcase our art and artists," says Menon. With Tyeb Mehta's work fetching a record-breaking \$1.58 million (Rs 6.5 crore) at Christie's auction in New York and Souza's selling for

\$1.36 million (Rs 5.8 crore) at Sotheby's, artists like Dodiya have also had sold-out shows abroad. Kallat is not new to international art fairs like the ones in Basel, Switzerland, and Miami. He will showcase a "not-for-sale" sculpture especially created for IAS. Renu Modi of Gallery Espace says, "It's about time we had an art fair of our own, especially with so much talk about Indian art making inroads into the global market."

Conceptualised and put together by Hanmer MS&L, headed by Sunil Gautam, the IAS has been conceived as an annual event. "In the first year, the focus is modern and contemporary Indian art," says Gautam. It expects to attract international buyers and collectors, besides building a base for foreign gallery presence. The IAS will also comprise an art forum with a day-long session with speakers and moderators. Gautam has bigger plans for next year, promising it will be "at least three times bigger than 2008 in both scale and participation". It might not be Art Basel yet, but it certainly promises to leave a mark.

by **Nirmala Ravindran**

SOUL OF ARTISTS: Anjolie Ela Menon with her work



FAWAZ MUSAN

music festival

All in the Family

DELHI It is a rare festival where carnatic music's Generation Next gets a platform to showcase its talent through the festival, Flights of Fantasy, a three-day musical treat from August 25 to 27. On the first day, listen to the violin duet by Ganesh and Kumaresh. Both brothers display great sensitivity and maturity in their concerts. It is amazing to watch them play as they are not only violinists but composers and singers as well. The second day features vocalist Sanjay Subrahmanyam, who began learning music at the age of seven. His initial years were spent under the tutelage of V. Lakshminarayana on the violin as well as in vocal music. The artiste's vibrant style is an amalgamation of the great maestros but yet has a distinct stamp of his own. The last day will feature the Priya Sisters—Haripriya and Shanmukha—who grew up learning from their father, Subbaraman. Eclectic performances not to be missed at the India Habitat Centre.

by **S. Sahaya Ranjit**

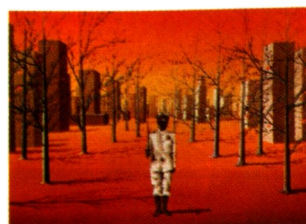
BEAT OF THE GENES: Ganesh and Kumaresh



art

Life from an Angle

DELHI Metropolis and The Self, a show organised by Art Alive, captures the dialogue between the self and the metro cities by bringing together artists from smaller cities to metropolitans, in which each work of art is portrayed through unusual angles. They depict mixed emotions of those living in cities. The list of



A work by Pratul Dash

artists comprises Apurva Desai, C.F. John, Debraj Goswami, Pratul Dash, Murali Cheeroth, T.M. Azis, Veer Munshi. At Art Alive Gallery, from August 22 to September 2.